Getting Your Page Indexed: A Practical SEO Checklist

A simple checklist for making sure a webpage can be found, understood, and indexed by Google.

Use this guide when: you publish a new page, update an important page, or see “Not indexed” / “Soft 404” in Google Search Console.

1. First: Can Google Access and Index the Page?

1. Open Google Search Console — Use URL Inspection and paste the exact page URL.

2. Check the indexing result — Look for “URL is on Google” or a reason the page is not indexed.

3. Check the technical signals — Confirm Crawl allowed = Yes, Page fetch = Successful, Indexing allowed = Yes, and the canonical URL is correct.

4. Check the XML sitemap — Make sure the page appears in your sitemap and that the sitemap is submitted in Search Console.

5. Use Test Live URL after changes — This checks the current page, not an older crawl stored by Google.

6. Request indexing — After the live test passes, request indexing. Google still decides when and whether to index the page.

Important: A page can be crawlable and still not be indexed. “Allowed to index” only means Google is permitted to index it.

2. What Content Can Google Actually See?

Modern pages often load content with JavaScript, third-party widgets, calendars, product feeds, or other external scripts. Google can run JavaScript, but important content should still be tested because rendering can fail, be delayed, or differ from what a person sees in a browser.

Check	How	What it tells you
Raw HTML	Right-click → View Page Source	What the server sends before JavaScript runs.
Rendered browser DOM	DevTools → Elements	What appears after the browser runs scripts.
Google rendered HTML	Search Console → Test Live URL → View tested page → HTML	What Google can see after it renders the page.

Simple test: Choose one unique piece of page content (for example a product name, event title, price, location, or sentence). Search for the exact text in all three places above.

If content appears only after JavaScript runs: Google may still index it, but verify it in Google’s rendered HTML. For critical SEO content, server-rendered or static HTML is safer when possible.

3. If Search Console Says “Soft 404”

A soft 404 usually means the server returned a normal page (often HTTP 200), but Google believes the page looks empty, broken, or not useful enough to index.

Quick fix workflow

- Confirm the page really has a useful purpose and is not an empty placeholder.
- Add clear static text that explains what the page is about.
- Use one clear H1 and meaningful supporting headings where needed.
- Make sure important content is visible without requiring unusual clicks, logins, or blocked scripts.
- Add internal links from relevant pages so Google can discover and understand the page in context.
- Re-run Test Live URL. If the live test is healthy, request indexing again.
- Check Search Console later to see whether the Last crawl date updates and the page becomes indexed.

Do not add filler text just to increase word count. Add useful, page-specific content that helps a human understand what the page offers.

4. On-Page SEO: Keep It Clear and Human

The targets below use practical recommended ranges for common on-page SEO fields. Use them as simple optimization targets while keeping every title, heading, description, and paragraph natural, specific, and useful to the reader.

Element	Recommended range / target	Example
Focus keyphrase	Recommended range: 4-6 content words, roughly 20-50 characters. Keep it specific and closely matched to what a user would actually search.	fresh organic fruits delivery
SEO title	Recommended range: 50-60 characters, usually about 6-10 words. Put the primary topic/keyphrase near the beginning and keep the title clear and compelling.	Fresh Organic Fruits | Green Market
Meta description	Recommended range: 120-156 characters, usually about 18-25 words. Summarize the page clearly, include the focus keyphrase naturally, and give users a reason to click.	Shop fresh organic fruits, seasonal produce, and healthy favorites from Green Market. Browse quality produce and order fresh today.
H1 page heading	Recommended range: 20-60 characters, usually about 3-10 words. Use one clear H1 that states the page topic and naturally includes the primary keyphrase when appropriate.	Fresh Organic Fruits

Overall page text	Recommended range for a standard content page: about 300-800 words, roughly 1,800-5,000 characters. Use only the amount of content needed to fully explain the page and satisfy the user's intent.	Add useful, page-specific information that helps visitors understand the topic, answer common questions, and navigate to related pages.

Reminder: meeting the recommended ranges is helpful, but it does not guarantee ranking. The page should still be useful, accurate, crawlable, and written for people first.

Focus keyphrase

- Choose one phrase that closely matches what a real person would search.
- Keep it specific. Avoid a string of unrelated keywords.
- Use it naturally in the SEO title, H1, intro copy, and content when appropriate.

SEO title

- Put the main topic near the beginning.
- Make every important page title unique.
- Avoid vague titles such as “Home,” “Page,” or “Products.”
- Do not stuff the title with repeated keyword variations.

Meta description

- Write one clear summary of the page and its value.
- Use natural language—not a keyword list.
- Make it specific to the page.
- Google may rewrite the snippet based on the search query, so page content still matters.

Page description and content

- Explain the page immediately in plain language.
- Use one H1 for the main page topic, then H2/H3 headings to organize sections.
- Keep important information as normal HTML text whenever practical.
- Write for people first. Good SEO content should also be useful content.

5. Build a Crawlable Link Structure

Internal links are especially important. They connect pages inside your own website and give crawlers clear paths from one page to another. Link related pages using descriptive anchor text instead of “click here.”

External links can also be useful. Link to relevant, trustworthy sources when they help the reader. Inbound links from other websites can also help Google discover pages and understand their importance.

Think of the website as a web, not a collection of isolated pages. Important pages should be reachable through normal navigation or contextual internal links.

6. Final Pre-Publish Checklist

- ☐ Page returns normally and loads for users.
- ☐ Page is not set to noindex.
- ☐ Canonical URL points to the correct page.
- ☐ Page is included in the XML sitemap.
- ☐ Google Search Console Live Test says the page can be indexed.
- ☐ Critical content is visible in Google’s rendered HTML.

☐ One clear focus keyphrase is selected.
☐ SEO title is clear, unique, and concise.
☐ Meta description accurately summarizes the page.
☐ Page has one clear H1 and useful body copy.
☐ Images have appropriate alt text when they convey meaning.
☐ Relevant internal links point to and from the page.
☐ After important changes, request indexing and check Search Console again later.